Carpaia

Seed: C9500-B-R-A2-K7Q2MB
City · Late Middle Ages · River
Place of adventure, danger 2 · 9,500 inhabitants
Scale: one row of letters = 60.4 ft, one column = half

History

Carpaia grew around Puccio di Spinello's castle and broke free of it through a long struggle and a charter signed by the emperor. A heretic was burned in the square; his daughter swore revenge and vanished. A three-month siege ended when someone opened a postern by night: no one knows who.

The threat: Held by brigands

A band of brigands led by Lando Salimbeni has taken over Carpaia: they squeeze the inhabitants, hold the notables hostage and use no. 19 (The Mortar Inn) as their headquarters.

Who is behind it: Lando Salimbeni, leader (Thief 3 · AC 6 [13] · 5hp · THAC0 19 [+0] · ML 10 · AL Chaotic): devout, quotes saints in every sentence; wants a safe escort for a precious load; secret: is a spy for an enemy town.

If nobody steps in (one step every 1d4 days)

1. They execute a notable in the square.
2. Reinforcements arrive: 2d6 more brigands.
3. They burn a quarter and leave with the loot.

Wandering monsters (d6; every 2 turns at night, every hour by day: 1 in 6)

1. Lando Salimbeni's brigands: the threat itself, roaming the streets.
2. Hippogriff (1d6) · danger 2, HD ~3-4: half eagle, half horse, nesting in abandoned towers.
3. Giant spider (1d6) · danger 2, HD ~3-4: spiders as big as ponies, weaving webs between the pillars.
4. Serpent folk (1d6) · danger 2, HD ~3-4: an ancient race of serpents with human bodies, devoted to forgotten gods.
5. Living statue (1d6) · danger 2, HD ~3-4: a statue of crystal, iron or stone that wakes to defend a place.
6. Gargoyle (1d6) · danger 2, HD ~3-4: a winged statue that comes alive when no one is looking.

Government and factions

Isotta Geremei, the foreign podestà (Fighter 6 · AC 4 [15] · 22hp · THAC0 17 [+2] · ML 8 · AL Chaotic): tired and ill, always coughing; wants more customers, at any cost; secret: made a pact with something in the woods. (lives at no. 10)

· The Butchers' guild. Goal: to lower the tolls on goods. Led by Bice da Todi, leader.
· The foreign merchants. Goal: a warehouse of their own and their own laws. Led by Iacopo di Ubaldo, leader. Rival: the cathedral chapter.
· The cathedral chapter. Goal: to recover the lands taken from the bishop. Led by Berta Varano,

leader.

Demographics

9,500 people on 52.8 hectares (180 per hectare), in about 3,167 dwellings; on the map 42 numbered buildings: in big places every box is a group of houses or a block.

Noble households: 48. Lawyers: 15. Clergy: 238, of whom priests: 8; places of worship: 24. Guards and watchmen: 32 (few: a slack town). Livestock: 20,900, two thirds of it fowl.

Shops and trades: shoemakers 45, furriers 23, maidservants 27, tailors 21, barbers 16, jewellers 13, taverns 15, old-clothes sellers 18, pastrycooks 14, masons 14, carpenters 11, weavers 12, chandlers 8, mercers 10, coopers 9, bakers 8, water carriers 7, scabbard makers 5, wine sellers 6, hatters 7, saddlers 6, poulterers 8, purse makers 6, butchers 5, fishmongers 7, beer sellers 3, spice merchants 4, blacksmiths 3, painters 3, doctors 5, locksmiths 3, bathers 2, ropemakers 4, inns 3, tanners 3, copyists 4, sculptors 3, harness makers 3, cutlers 2, glovers 2, woodcarvers 2, magic shops 1, bookbinders 2, illuminators 1, booksellers 1.

Numbers from S. John Ross's Medieval Demographics Made Easy: every shop is in town, the map shows the 42 most important ones.

Countryside and economy

The country around is core land, fully farmed: about 2,500 peasants live in the surrounding 6-mile hex, in 10 villages.

The lord's net revenue: 75 gp a month (900 gp a year), already divided by 2 for the troubled times.

Property for sale

- Inn (500 gp): 5 sp a month net profit (6 gp a year). With 4 servants. Seller: Usanna Badnight.
- Large farm (500 gp): 12 gp a month in a good year (a knight's monthly expenses). With 3 tenants. Seller: Novella da Messina.
- Large manor (10,000 gp): 75 gp a month; +10 gp a month for each protected village. With 8 tenant families and 4d6 families paying homage. Seller: Tancia the Red.

Rules from Coins and Scrolls (OSR: Land and Investments): land is rarely sold, it is more often inherited, given or seized. In times of plague, war or famine every income is halved; in truly chaotic times it is divided by 10. Whoever cheats on taxes keeps another 5% of the income, until a careful lord audits the books.

Rumours and events

Rumours (d8; T true, F false: referee only)

1. Lando Salimbeni's brigands fear fire more than swords. [T]
2. The parish's holy water is enough to drive every evil from here. [F]
3. Mea Varano (no. 33) is really a noble in disguise. [F]
4. Lando Salimbeni's brigands are just a tale to scare children. [F]
5. A knight left for the Keep of Spolino a month ago and never came back; his sword was worth a castle. [T]
6. Hippogriff prowls near the graveyard at night. [T]
7. The lord is about to raise taxes to pay for a war. [T]
8. In the woods to the north there's a witch who buys hair and teeth. [T]

Events during the stay (d6)

1. A merchant offers a reward for a stolen letter.
2. An execution in the square: the condemned swears innocence and names a name.
3. Feast of the patron saint: foreign merchants, jugglers, pickpockets everywhere.
4. A wedding between two families: everyone is invited, adventurers too.
5. Fire alarm at night: everyone to the buckets, and someone takes advantage of the chaos.
6. A procession blocks the streets; whoever doesn't kneel gets dark looks.

Walls, gates and secrets

Stone walls, with a water-filled moat.

· [A] Sally Gate (south)
· [B] Lion Gate (west)
· [C] Sally Gate (north-east)
· Secret posterns in the walls: 2 ($ on the referee's map).
· Secret tunnel from no. 10 (Baglioni Citadel) to beyond the walls (⁘ on the referee's map).

The buildings

Sally Gate Quarter

1 Friary of St Blaise (friary, stone)

Built against the walls, where land was cheap.
Lapo Ironeater, prior (Cleric 5 · AC 3 [16] · 13hp · THAC0 17 [+2] · ML 7 · AL Neutral · Spells: light, cure light wounds, bless, speak with animals): cheerful and gossipy; wants to marry their daughter well; secret: poisoned his first wife. 9 people live here.

2 The Ram (tavern, stone)

A cellar dug into the rock where people gamble.
Gualtiero Pallavicino, tavern keeper (Normal human · AC 9 [10] · HD ½ (4hp) · ML 8 · AL Neutral): cheerful and gossipy; wants to ruin a rival; secret: none, but everyone thinks otherwise.

3 Commune Palace (town hall, stone)

Crenellated, with the civic tower, the council bell and the loggia where sentences are read.
Elisabetta Fairbrow, notary and chancellor (Normal human · AC 9 [10] · HD ½ (1hp) · ML 6 · AL Chaotic): always drunk after vespers; wants the lord's favour; secret: hides a heretic in the cellar. 4 people live here.

4 Surgeon Rosaspina's Shop (barber-surgeon, stone)

A brass basin hung outside, a chair with straps, saws that are (almost) clean.
Rosaspina di Dino, surgeon (Normal human · AC 9 [10] · HD ½ (3hp) · ML 8 · AL Neutral): proud of their lineage; wants to leave this place for good; secret: none: they really are a good person. 3 people live here.

5 Astrologer Emilia's House (astrologer's house, stone)

A garret with a spyglass, coloured smoke from the chimney.
Emilia Hardhead, astrologer (Magic-user 7 · AC 9 [10] · 18hp · THAC0 17 [+2] · ML 8 · AL Lawful · Spells: sleep, magic missile, read languages, ESP, invisibility, dispel magic, fireball): loyal to the lord unto death; wants news of a spouse gone to war; secret: becomes something else at night.

6 Spinola Palace (noble palace, stone)

Rusticated ground floor, an arcaded courtyard, stone benches along the façade.
Ubaldo di Donato, lord (Fighter 2 · AC 3 [16] · 12hp · THAC0 19 [+0] · ML 8 · AL Neutral): a stickler for rules and contracts; wants to avenge a murdered brother; secret: knows a passage under the walls. 13 people

live here.

7 Mother church of St Justina (church, stone)

A porch where the old folk gather and contracts are sealed.

Giannozzo Chiaramonte, parish priest (Cleric 4 · AC 5 [14] · 19hp · THAC0 19 [+0] · ML 7 · AL Neutral · Spells: detect evil, protection from evil, hold person): superstitious, wears charms everywhere; wants a genuine relic; secret: is a spy for an enemy town. 2 people live here.

8 Colonna Bank (bank, stone)

A green-baize counter under an arcade, armed guards at the door.

Neri the Red, banker (Normal human · AC 9 [10] · HD ½ (4hp) · ML 8 · AL Neutral): a braggart who tells made-up deeds; wants a forbidden book; secret: is a spy for an enemy town. 3 people live here.

Monsters: Living statue (1d6) · danger 2, HD ~3-4.

9 The Mortar Tavern (tavern, stone)

A cellar dug into the rock where people gamble.

Nella Pallavicino, tavern keeper (Normal human · AC 9 [10] · HD ½ (3hp) · ML 8 · AL Neutral): always drunk after vespers; wants news of a spouse gone to war; secret: none, but everyone thinks otherwise.

Clue: an empty pedestal (from no. 8).

10 Baglioni Citadel (citadel, stone)

A square keep, an inner moat and a drawbridge toward the square.

Corrado Spinola, castellan (Fighter 4 · AC 4 [15] · 22hp · THAC0 17 [+2] · ML 10 · AL Chaotic): a dreamer who longs for adventure; wants the lord's favour; secret: secretly loves a member of the rival family. 10 people live here.

the foreign podestà resides here.

The secret tunnel leaving past the walls starts here (⁘ on the referee's map).

Lion Gate Quarter

11 Dianora's Mill (mill, stone)

The miller weighs with a steelyard everyone says is rigged.

Dianora Tizzoni, miller (Normal human · AC 9 [10] · HD ½ (1hp) · ML 6 · AL Lawful): laughs at everything, even funerals; wants a genuine relic; secret: none, but everyone thinks otherwise. 3 people live here.

12 Lambertazzi Tower (tower house, stone)

Putlog holes for flying bridges to the allies' towers.

Uberto Guidi, head of the family (Fighter 4 · AC 3 [16] · 18hp · THAC0 17 [+2] · ML 10 · AL Lawful): cynical, has seen too many wars; wants to marry their daughter well; secret: pays the thieves' guild to be left alone. 8 people live here.

13 The Mermaid Tavern (tavern, stone)

Low and smoky, a branch hung over the door, long benches.

Usanna Orsini, tavern keeper (Normal human · AC 9 [10] · HD ½ (2hp) · ML 8 · AL Neutral): tired and ill, always coughing; wants to pay off a debt to the bank; secret: hides a heretic in the cellar.

Clue: a sack of stolen supplies, half empty (from no. 16).

14 The Mermaid (tavern, stone)

Low and smoky, a branch hung over the door, long benches.

Dino da Rimini, tavern keeper (Normal human · AC 9 [10] · HD ½ (4hp) · ML 8 · AL Chaotic): hot-tempered, quick to the knife; wants to pay off a debt to the bank; secret: none: they really are a good person. 2 people live here.

15 Visconti Palace (noble palace, stone)

Rusticated ground floor, an arcaded courtyard, stone benches along the façade.

Tano Correggio, lord (Fighter 4 · AC 5 [14] · 22hp · THAC0 17 [+2] · ML 8 · AL Neutral): a shrewd haggler; wants a forbidden book; secret: is the lord's illegitimate child. 8 people live here.

16 Cathedral of St Lucy (cathedral, stone)

Soaring vaults, stained glass and a treasury kept in the sacristy behind three locks.

Novella di Ottaviano, mitred abbess (Cleric 6 · AC 3 [16] · 18hp · THAC0 17 [+2] · ML 8 · AL Chaotic · Spells: cure light wounds, remove fear, speak with animals, bless, locate object): learned, speaks Latin to customers; wants to marry their daughter well; secret: was banished from another town. 8 people live here.

Monsters: Serpent folk (1d6) · danger 2, HD ~3-4.

Treasure (5,900 gp): 4,000 gp, 2 gems (100 gp, 500 gp), 1 piece of jewellery (1,300 gp); in a stolen chest.

17 Church of St Frigidian (church, stone)

A low crypt with the founders' tombs, shut by a rusty gate.

Maso Longsword, parish priest (Cleric 2 · AC 5 [14] · 6hp · THAC0 19 [+0] · ML 9 · AL Neutral · Spells: detect evil): always drunk after vespers; wants to marry their daughter well; secret: becomes something else at night. 2 people live here.

Monsters: Giant spider (1d6) · danger 2, HD ~3-4.

18 Guardhouse (guardhouse, stone)

A rack of spears, a ledger of who comes and goes, dice on the table.

Matilde Baglioni, captain of the guard (Fighter 2 · AC 2 [17] · 10hp · THAC0 19 [+0] · ML 9 · AL Neutral): generous to those in need; wants a forbidden book; secret: made a pact with something in the woods. 8 people live here.

St Romuald Quarter

19 The Mortar Inn (inn, stone)

A yard for merchants' carts and a well of its own.

Filippa Longsword, innkeeper (Normal human · AC 9 [10] · HD ½ (2hp) · ML 7 · AL Chaotic): laughs at everything, even funerals; wants to avenge a murdered brother; secret: becomes something else at night. 2 people live here.

Lair: Lando Salimbeni's brigands (3d6).

20 The Sun Apothecary (apothecary, stone)

Majolica jars with Latin names, a stuffed crocodile hanging from the ceiling.

Bice Visconti, apothecary (Magic-user 3 · AC 9 [10] · 11hp · THAC0 19 [+0] · ML 10 · AL Neutral · Spells: shield, charm person, ESP): melancholy, recently widowed; wants that nobody digs under their house; secret: none: they really are a good person. 2 people live here.

Clue: a trail of small holes in the dust, as if from many legs (from no. 17).

21 The Crane Apothecary (apothecary, stone)

Majolica jars with Latin names, a stuffed crocodile hanging from the ceiling.

Agnese di Cecco, apothecary (Magic-user 1 · AC 9 [10] · 1hp · THAC0 19 [+0] · ML 9 · AL Neutral · Spells: charm person): a shrewd haggler; wants to ruin a rival; secret: forges coins.

Clue: the remains of a fire and a forgotten knife (from no. 19).

22 Armoury (armoury, stone)

Racks of pikes, crossbows, greased armour on stands.

Bice Hardhead, master-at-arms (Fighter 4 · AC 5 [14] · 13hp · THAC0 17 [+2] · ML 9 · AL Neutral): a dreamer who longs for adventure; wants to know who steals their hens; secret: is a spy for an enemy town.

23 Church of St George (church, stone)

Last Judgement frescoes blackened by candle smoke.

Ottavia the One-Eyed, priestess (Cleric 3 · AC 3 [16] · 14hp · THAC0 19 [+0] · ML 8 · AL Lawful · Spells:

remove fear, protection from evil): always drunk after vespers; wants that nobody digs under their house; secret: none, but everyone thinks otherwise. 2 people live here.

24 Studium Generale (university, stone)

Lecture halls round a courtyard, foreign students grouped by nation, frequent brawls.

Ezzelino Varano, rector of the university (Magic-user 4 · AC 9 [10] · 13hp · THAC0 19 [+0] · ML 8 · AL Neutral · Spells: detect magic, sleep, levitate, wizard lock): a dreamer who longs for adventure; wants to avenge a murdered brother; secret: is a spy for an enemy town. 16 people live here.

25 Butchers' Guild Hall (guild hall, stone)

The guild's arms carved above the door, a hall with the statutes chained to a lectern.

Gherardo di Castruccio, guild consul (Normal human · AC 9 [10] · HD ½ (1hp) · ML 6 · AL Neutral): proud of their lineage; wants to avenge a murdered brother; secret: becomes something else at night. 4 people live here.

Clue: feathers, scales and fur from no known animal (from no. 31).

26 Hospital of St Lawrence (hospital, stone)

A foundling wheel on the street, a pharmacy at the back.

Cecco Salimbeni, rector (Cleric 1 · AC 4 [15] · 4hp · THAC0 19 [+0] · ML 7 · AL Neutral): hot-tempered, quick to the knife; wants to find a lost ring; secret: poisoned his first wife. 11 people live here.

27 Fieschi Tower (tower house, stone)

Putlog holes for flying bridges to the allies' towers.

Gemma Pico, head of the family (Fighter 4 · AC 2 [17] · 10hp · THAC0 17 [+2] · ML 8 · AL Neutral): a stickler for rules and contracts; wants to leave this place for good; secret: owns a treasure map they can't read. 9 people live here.

28 Pepoli Palace (noble palace, stone)

Rusticated ground floor, an arcaded courtyard, stone benches along the façade.

Ubaldo da Aquileia, lord (Fighter 3 · AC 3 [16] · 8hp · THAC0 19 [+0] · ML 9 · AL Lawful): melancholy, recently widowed; wants to pay off a debt to the bank; secret: forges coins. 11 people live here.

29 The Serpent Inn (inn, stone)

A wrought iron sign, a big fireplace, the common room above the stable.

Zanobi di Folco, innkeeper (Normal human · AC 9 [10] · HD ½ (1hp) · ML 6 · AL Neutral): kind but terrified of everything; wants to leave this place for good; secret: knows a passage under the walls. 5 people live here.

30 The Wheel Inn (inn, stone)

A wrought iron sign, a big fireplace, the common room above the stable.

Rosaspina da Chioggia, innkeeper (Normal human · AC 9 [10] · HD ½ (2hp) · ML 6 · AL Lawful): proud of their lineage; wants more customers, at any cost; secret: sells well water as holy water. 5 people live here.

31 Buondelmonti Tower (tower house, stone)

Tall and narrow, the door on the first floor up a ladder that can be pulled in.

Simone Ironeater, head of the family (Fighter 1 · AC 5 [14] · 3hp · THAC0 19 [+0] · ML 7 · AL Lawful): shy, stammers; wants forgiveness for an old sin; secret: was banished from another town. 2 people live here.

Monsters: Hippogriff (1d6) · danger 2, HD ~3-4.

Outside the walls

32 Giannozzo's Boatyard (boatyard, timber)

Hulls on wooden slipways, a smell of pitch.

Giannozzo Scaligeri, shipwright (Normal human · AC 9 [10] · HD ½ (2hp) · ML 8 · AL Lawful): cynical, has seen too many wars; wants a forbidden book; secret: is the lord's illegitimate child. 5 people live here.

33 Mea's Boatyard (boatyard, timber)

Hulls on wooden slipways, a smell of pitch.

Mea Varano, shipwright (Normal human · AC 9 [10] · HD ½ (4hp) · ML 6 · AL Lawful): proud of their lineage; wants to pay off a debt to the bank; secret: none, but everyone thinks otherwise. 7 people live here.

34 Chiaramonte Warehouse (warehouse, stone)

Bales of wool, barrels of oil, salt and a guard dog that never sleeps.

Caterina di Ezzelino, warehouse master (Normal human · AC 9 [10] · HD ½ (4hp) · ML 7 · AL Neutral): a shrewd haggler; wants a genuine relic; secret: was banished from another town. 3 people live here.

35 The Serpent Bathhouse (bathhouse, stone)

Steam, wooden tubs, and more business than washing.

Piccarda di Lando, bathkeeper (Normal human · AC 9 [10] · HD ½ (3hp) · ML 6 · AL Lawful): superstitious, wears charms everywhere; wants a cure for a sick child; secret: sells well water as holy water. 6 people live here.

36 Fieschi Dye Works (dye works, stone)

The river runs red, blue and yellow below it; cloth stretched over the roofs.

Vanni Salimbeni, master dyer (Normal human · AC 9 [10] · HD ½ (3hp) · ML 6 · AL Lawful): miserly to the last penny; wants news of a spouse gone to war; secret: keeps a magic item they don't know how to use. 5 people live here.

37 Caterina's Tannery (tannery, timber)

Vats of lime and urine, a stench that keeps the curious away.

Caterina Longsword, tanner (Normal human · AC 9 [10] · HD ½ (3hp) · ML 6 · AL Lawful): devout, quotes saints in every sentence; wants to pay off a debt to the bank; secret: witnessed a murder and keeps quiet. 6 people live here.

38 Fish Market (fish market, stone)

Marble counters washed every evening, gulls and cats squabbling.

Lotario di Rinaldo, fishmonger (Normal human · AC 9 [10] · HD ½ (1hp) · ML 6 · AL Lawful): proud of their lineage; wants a safe escort for a precious load; secret: pays the thieves' guild to be left alone.

39 Lisa's Farmstead (farmstead, stone)

House and byre under one roof, a well with a pulley.

Lisa Pio, tenant farmer (Normal human · AC 9 [10] · HD ½ (4hp) · ML 6 · AL Chaotic): obsessed with cleanliness; wants a forbidden book; secret: secretly loves a member of the rival family. 6 people live here.

40 Lapo's Farmstead (farmstead, stone)

House and byre under one roof, a well with a pulley.

Lapo di Ubaldo, tenant farmer (Normal human · AC 9 [10] · HD ½ (2hp) · ML 8 · AL Lawful): miserly to the last penny; wants to pay off a debt to the bank; secret: is in debt up to the neck. 3 people live here.

41 Dianora's Farmstead (farmstead, stone)

House and byre under one roof, a well with a pulley.

Dianora Beccaria, tenant farmer (Normal human · AC 9 [10] · HD ½ (1hp) · ML 7 · AL Neutral): obsessed with cleanliness; wants a genuine relic; secret: made a pact with something in the woods. 8 people live here.

42 Abbey of St Blaise (monastery, stone)

A cloister, a scriptorium, a cellar and an infirmary stocked from the herb garden.

Duccio da Lecce, abbot (Cleric 7 · AC 3 [16] · 26hp · THAC0 17 [+2] · ML 10 · AL Lawful · Spells: light, protection from evil, remove fear, hold person, find traps, continual light, locate object): superstitious, wears charms everywhere; wants a safe escort for a precious load; secret: poisoned his first wife. 10 people live here.

Sources

Monsters, clues and treasure come from WyrmDelve (treasure: Old-School Essentials SRD, Open Game License 1.0a). Population, density and trades: S. John Ross, Medieval Demographics Made Easy. Country, revenue and property: Skerples, OSR: Land and Investments (Coins and Scrolls). Only the numbers of these sources are used.